



AI Highlight

Physical trauma reactions can continue after the danger is over, even when you know you're safe. With complex or developmental trauma, going straight for the deepest memory can be overwhelming. Instead of diving off the deep end heroically, take it easy, one step at a time. As Buddhist nun Pema Chodron says, "feather touch" is all it takes to gently open up. Peter Levine, the founder of Somatic Experiencing, calls this gentle work around the edges, "pendulation."

The same principle extends to inner-child therapy: you can know exactly what the younger part needs and still get pulled so far into the child-state that there isn't enough adult perspective left to give it.

